

Cheesecake winner

Williamsburg resident Gloria Pleasants won the cheesecake category in the 1988 "Philly" Hall of Fame Recipe Contest sponsored by Kraft, Inc. Ms. Pleasants, one of 6,000 entrants, won a trip for two to New Orleans for her white chocolate cheesecake recipe. Here's her recipe:

WHITE CHOCOLATE CHEESECAKE

For crust:

- 1½ cups flour
- ½ cup sugar
- ½ cup margarine
- ½ cup finely chopped almonds or macadamia nuts, toasted
- 4 1-ounce squares white baking chocolate, grated
- 1 egg, beaten

For filling:

- 8 1-ounce squares white baking chocolate, chopped

- ⅓ cup whipping cream
- 1 tablespoon vanilla extract
- 3 8-ounce packages cream cheese, softened
- 1 14-ounce can sweetened condensed milk
- 3 eggs

To make crust, combine flour and sugar. Cut in margarine until mixture resembles coarse crumbs. Stir in remaining ingredients; mix well. Press onto bottom and sides of 9-inch springform pan. Chill.

For filling, combine chocolate and cream in double boiler; cook, stirring constantly over simmering water, until chocolate is melted. Stir in vanilla; keep warm.

In a separate bowl combine cream cheese and milk, mixing at medium speed on electric mixer until well blended. Add eggs, one at a time, mixing well after each addition. Stir in chocolate mixture, mixing well. Pour over crust. Bake at 325 degrees for 1 hour and 20 minutes. Loosen cake from rim of pan. Cool before removing rim of pan. Chill. Garnish with strawberries and powdered sugar if desired.

Makes 12-14 servings.